MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARRIER, BODY ARMOR, AIRCREWMAN, SMALL ARMS PROTECTIVE

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the requirements for the design, materials, and fabrication of a carrier for small arms protective body armor for aircrewmen in three sizes: Short, Regular, and Long.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this purchase description to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-T-285	-	Thread, Polyester
JJ-W-155	-	Webbing, Textile (Cotton, Elastic)
UU-P-268	-	Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping
DDD-L-20	-	Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage (General Use).
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-C-508	-	Cloth, Oxford, Nylon, 3 Ounce
MIL-B-543	-	Buckles, Tongueless and Web Strap
MIL-W-4088	-	Webbing, Textile, Woven Nylon
MIL-W-5664	-	Webbing, Textile, Elastic, Cotton
MIL-F-10884	-	Fasteners, Snap
MIL-F-21840	-	Fastener Tape, Hook and Pile, Nylon
MIL-C-43191	-	Cloth, Wind Resistant Sateen, Cotton and Nylon
MIL-F-43539(GL)	-	Felt, Ballistic, Nylon

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

Fed. Std. No. 751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MS 27980	-	Fasteners, Snap, Style 2 (Regular Wire Spring Clamp Type)

FSC 8470

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DRAWINGS

ARMY NATICK LABORATORIES

2-3-205 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Assembly Complete.
2-3-206 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Front Assembly.
2-3-207 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Back Assembly.
2-3-208 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "A".
2-3-209 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "B".
2-3-210 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "C".
2-3-211 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "D".
2-3-212 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "E".
2-3-213 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Sections "A".
2-3-214 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Sections "B".
2-3-221 - Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective; Details "F".

(Figures 1 through 5 are miniature reproductions of referenced drawings and are attached for information only).

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Samples.-

3.1.1 Guide samples.- Guide samples of the end item, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.3). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.1.2 Preproduction sample approval.- When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced; a sample of the finished carrier shall be submitted to or made ready for the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection as specified in 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this

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specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured by the supplier in the same facility to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.2 Materials.-

3.2.1 Cloth, wind resistant sateen, cotton and nylon.- The cotton and nylon cloth used for the body of the carrier, Olive Green 107, shall conform to MIL-C-43191.

3.2.2 Cloth, oxford, nylon, 3 ounce.- The nylon oxford cloth used for the pocket shall be dyed Olive Green 106, to match the standard sample, and conform to type I, class 1 of MIL-C-508.

3.2.3 Fasteners, tape, hook and pile, nylon.- The nylon tape fasteners shall be dyed Olive Green 106 to match the standard sample and conform to type II, 1-inch and 2-inch widths of MIL-F-21840.

3.2.4 Webbing, textile, elastic cotton.- The 1-inch cotton elastic webbing used for the waistband retaining strap shall be dyed OD-7, and conform to class 1, of MIL-W-5664.

3.2.5 Webbing, textile, (cotton, elastic).- The cotton elastic webbing used for side adjustment strap shall be 1 inch wide, conforming to type I, class 21 of JJ-W-155 except that the color shall be OD-7 and shall be mildew resistant treated.

3.2.6 Webbing nylon.- The nylon webbing shall be type II, 1 inch, OD-7 conforming to MIL-W-4088.

3.2.7 Felt, nylon.- The nylon felt filler for the shoulder pads and the cushion spall pads for the front and back assemblies of the carrier shall conform to MIL-F-43539 (GL).

3.2.8 Thread, polyester.- The thread for all stitching shall conform to type 1, class 1, sub-class B of V-T-285. Thread sizes shall be as follows:

All stitching except where stitching is through felt	Size B
where stitching is through felt	Size E

3.2.8.1 Color.- The thread shall be dyed shade S-1 (C.A.66022). The finished thread shall show fastness to chlorine bleaching equal to or better than the standard sample.

3.2.9 Fastener, snap.- The snap fasteners shall conform to style 2, finish 2 of MIL-F-10884, MS27980 as follows: button-1B, socket-6B-stud-7B, eyelet-8B.

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3.2.10 Buckle, nonslip.- The buckles shall conform to type V, class 3, size 1-inch, of MIL-B-543.

3.3 Construction.- The construction shall conform in all respects to the drawings listed in Section 2 and as specified herein.

3.3.1 Stitching, machine.- All machine stitching except bartacking shall conform to Fed. Std. No. 751 as follows:

For all stitching except overedge stitching; type 301, 10 to 12 stitches per inch.
For overedge stitching type 503 or 504, 8 to 12 stitches per inch.
All raw edges of closing seams shall be overedged together. Any of the operations cited in this specification may be performed with an automatic machine provided the requirements for stitch pattern, stitches per inch, size and type of thread are met, and at least three tying overlapping or back stitches are used to secure the ends of stitching.

3.3.1.1 Type 301 stitching.- Thread breaks in stitching shall be overstitched not less than 1 inch at each break. Stitching shall be backstitched at the ends not less than 1/2 inch, except where ends are turned under in a hem or held down by other stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching and the lock will be embedded in the materials sewed.

3.3.1.2 Overedge stitching.- Thread breaks in overedge stitching shall be over stitched not less than 3/4 inch at each break. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching.

3.3.1.3 Bartacking.- Bartacking shall be 1/2 ± 1/16 inch or 3/4 ± 1/16 as applicable. The 1/2 inch bartack shall contain 28 stitches and the 3/4 inch bartack shall contain 42 stitches.

3.3.1.4 Trimming of thread ends.- All thread ends shall be trimmed.

3.3.2 Setting of snap fasteners.- The hole, punched before inserting the male or female part of the fastener, shall be smaller than the outside diameter of the fastener tube so that the fastener tube must be forced through the hole. The fastener shall be securely clinched.

3.3.3 Fusing of nylon webbing.- All ends of nylon webbing shall be fused after cutting and before assembly.

3.3.4 Skiving of nylon felt.- The nylon felt used as the filler for the shoulder pads shall be skived in accordance with dimensions and in the location shown on Drawing No. 2-3-212.

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3.4 Marking.- All marking shall conform to DDD-L-20.

3.4.1 The letters U S, stock number, front or back plate designation, size, contract number, shall conform to type IV, class 9 in the size characters and location shown on drawings No. 2-3-208 and 2-3-209. Fastness to class 9 labels shall be as specified for class 5 labels.

3.4.2 Instruction label.- An instruction label shall be positioned on the body side of the back as shown on drawing 2-3-209. This label shall conform to type II, class 9, approximately 5-1/2 inches by 3 inches. The characters used in printing the label shall be of maximum size commensurate with the area and contents specified. The label shall be printed to read across the narrow dimension. The label shall be sewn in by stitching all around with a 1/8 inch stitch margin.

3.4.2.1 Contents.- The contents of the label shall be as follows:

THIS ARMOR MAY SAVE YOUR LIFE

1. It will protect vital areas against small arms fire up to 30 cal. AP, shell and grenade fragments.
2. Armor can be put on with both shoulder straps attached, or with right shoulder open.
3. Wear over shirt. Lap waist bands over front to hold armor firmly in place. Adjust shoulder webbing straps, lifting the armor to cover lower neck area.
4. For quick release: a. Grasp loop at end of elastic webbing on right waist band and pull. b. Pull up snap fastener tab on right shoulder adjustment strap.
5. Keep touch-and-close fasteners free of foreign matter.
6. Do not drop the armor and wear it at all times in combat.
7. Do not wear with parachutes.
8. Do not remove protective armor plate from carrier.

3.5 Fit.- The finished carrier shall fit the armor of applicable size for which it was designed, without strain on seams or excessive fullness. Armor required for fit examination shall be obtained from the office issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal (see 4.3.3.2).

3.6 Workmanship.- The finished carrier shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification and the occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.- Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of

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all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample inspection.- When required, the preproduction sample submitted in accordance with 3.1.2 shall be inspected as specified in 4.3.3.1 and 4.3.3.2 for compliance with design, construction, workmanship and fit requirements.

4.3 Inspection.- Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except when otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Component and material inspection.- In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.2 In-process inspection.- Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether construction details which cannot be examined in the finished product are in accordance with requirements indicated in the specification. Construction methods of sub-assemblies not in accordance with specification requirements shall be considered not acceptable.

4.3.3 Examination of the end item.- The defects found during the examination shall be classified in accordance with list shown in 4.3.3.1 and 4.3.3.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one completely fabricated carrier. The inspection level and acceptable quality level for these examinations shall be in accordance with 4.3.3.3.

4.3.3.1 Visual examination.-

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Fabric	Any hole, cut, tear, smash, broken or missing yarn.	X		
	Any abrasion mark.		X	
Felt, nylon	Any hole, cut or patch	X		
Fastener tape, hook and pile	Any cut, hole or tear.	X		
	Missing hooks.	X		
	Hooks flattened.	X		

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Webbing, nylon	Frayed or scalloped edges, not firmly or tightly woven. Ends not fused.	X		
Webbing, elastic	Cut, chafed, abraided, or otherwise damaged affecting serviceability.	X		
Hardware: General	Broken or malformed; corroded areas; burrs or sharp edges.	X		
	Finish omitted or not as specified			
	- on brass		X	
	- on steel	X		
	Any required component not specified type.	X		
	Any required component improperly set or reversed, failing to serve intended purpose.	X		
Snap fasteners	Fail to effect a secure closure.	X		
	Clinched excessively tight, cutting surrounding fabric.	X		
Seams and stitching	Up to and including 1/2 inch.			X
Open seams	More than 1/2 inch.		X	
NOTE:	A seam shall be classified as an open seam when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken, or when two or more continuous skipped stitches or run-offs occur.			
Run-offs (see open seams)				
Raw edges (except where required)	More than 1/2 inch when securely caught in stitching.		X	
NOTE:	Raw edges not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as open seams.			
Seam and stitch type	Wrong seam or stitch type.	X		

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching (cont'd)				
Stitching	Loose, resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, tight, resulting in tightness or puckering of fabric on seams.			X
Stitches per inch	One stitch less than minimum specified.			X
	Two or more stitches less than minimum specified.		X	
	One or more stitches in excess of maximum specified.			X
	NOTE: Variation in the number of stitches per inch caused by operator speeding up the machine and pulling the fabric in order to sew over heavy places, or in turning corners shall be classified as follows: (a) within the minor B defect classification - no defect (b) within the minor A defect classification - Minor B defect.			
Stitching margins, stitching gage	Not as specified, affecting serviceability.			X
Stitching ends (on stitch type 301)	Backstitched less than 1/2 inch (except when caught in other seams or stitching).		X	
Thread breaks	On stitch type 301, overstitched less than 1 inch.			X
	On overedged stitching, overstitching less than 3/4 inch.			X
	NOTE: Thread breaks not overstitched shall be classified as open seams.			
Stitching rows	One or more required rows of stitching omitted:			
	- seriously affecting serviceability	X		
	- affecting serviceability but not seriously.		X	

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching (cont'd)				
"W" Stitching	Height of "W" stitching less than specified by more than 1/8 inch.			X
Cleanness	Noticeable grease or oil stains, thread ends not trimmed throughout.			X
Components and assembly	Any component or required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein).	X		
	Needle chews.	X		
	Seams pleated or badly puckered.			X
	Mends, darns, or patches.	X		
Hems	Less than specified width on hems required to finish less than 3/4 inch.		X	
	Less than specified width by more than 1/8 inch on hems required to finish 3/4 inch or more.			X
Pockets and flap	Pocket set off center by more than 1/4 inch.			X
	Pencil pocket not parallel with center pocket by more than 1/8 inch.			X
	Pockets or flap not formed as specified.		X	
	Flap improperly set or distorted, failing to effect a full and smooth closure.		X	
Bartacks	One or more bartacks omitted.		X	
	Any bartack not as specified or not in specified location.			X
Reinforcements	Omitted or mislocated.		X	
Ends of shoulder straps	Not turned under and sewn as specified.	X		
Marking	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, misplaced or size of characters not as specified.	X		
Instruction label	Omitted, illegible, misplaced or not type and class specified.	X		

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4.3.3.2 Examination for fit.-

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Fit of armor in carrier			
	NOTE: Fit examination shall be accomplished with the armor for which the carrier is designed. The inspector shall ease the armor into the carrier without effort and close the opening securely with the touch and hold fastener tape.		
	Cover too small, i.e., armor fails to fit in carrier.	X	
	Touch and hold fastener fails to effect a smooth and secure closure.		X
	Cover too large, showing excessive fullness or wrinkles.		X

4.3.3.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels.- Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQLs) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

Examination	Inspection Level	AQL
4.3.3.1 Visual Examination	II	2.5 Major 6.5 Major and Minor A 15 total Major Minor A and B combined
4.3.3.2 Examination for fit	S-3	0 Major 4.0 Minor

4.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.- An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of Section 5 of the purchase description are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container

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fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or taping, inadequate stapling. Bulged or distorted container.
Content	Number per container is more or less than required.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging.- Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.- Five carriers of one size only, each alternately reversed top to bottom, shall be stacked to form a bundle. Prior to bundling, each carrier shall be completely assembled with straps and flaps secured in position. The bundle shall be securely cross-tied with cotton tape or twine.

5.1.2 Level C.- Carriers shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing.- Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A.- Thirty carriers of one size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard container conforming to style RSC-L, V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each container shall be fitted with a taped liner conforming to V3c of PPP-B-636. Level A bundles shall be packed flat two in length, one in width and three in depth within a shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced with flat strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Toward the end of the contract or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes may be packed within the same container.

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5.2.2 Level B.- Thirty carriers of one size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF or SF, variety SW, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a taped liner conforming to type CF, variety SW, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A bundles shall be packed two in length, one in width and three of depth within a shipping container. Each container shall have the contents completely covered on the top and bottom with a sheet of 30-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper conforming to grade B of UU-P-268. Each container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification. Toward the end of the contract, or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes may be packed within the same container.

5.2.2.1 When specified, shipping containers shall be fabricated from grade V3c or V3s fiberboard (see 6.2).

5.2.3 Level C.- Carriers packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.- In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Each bundle shall have attached a manila colored paper shipping tag bearing the appropriate identification marking.

5.3.1 Labels, mixed sizes.- Each shipping container, packed with mixed sizes, shall have securely attached to the end and side, directly under the printing or stencilling, a white paper lable 5 by 4 inches, with the words, "MIXED SIZES" plainly stamped or printed thereon, and under these words shall be legibly printed the correct quantity of sizes contained therein.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use.- The carrier covered by this specification is intended to be worn by combat aircrewmen to hold protective body armor in place.

6.2 Ordering data.- Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Whether a preproduction sample is required (see 3.1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2)
d. Whether carrier to be procured is for front plate or back plate, and size.
e. When V-board shipping containers are required for level B shipment (see 5.2.2.1).

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6.3 For access to samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

Custodian:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - GL, MD, MR

Propect No. 8470-A009

Review information is current as of the date of this document. For future coordination of changes to this document, draft circulation should be based on the information in the current Federal Supply Classification Listing of DOD Documents.

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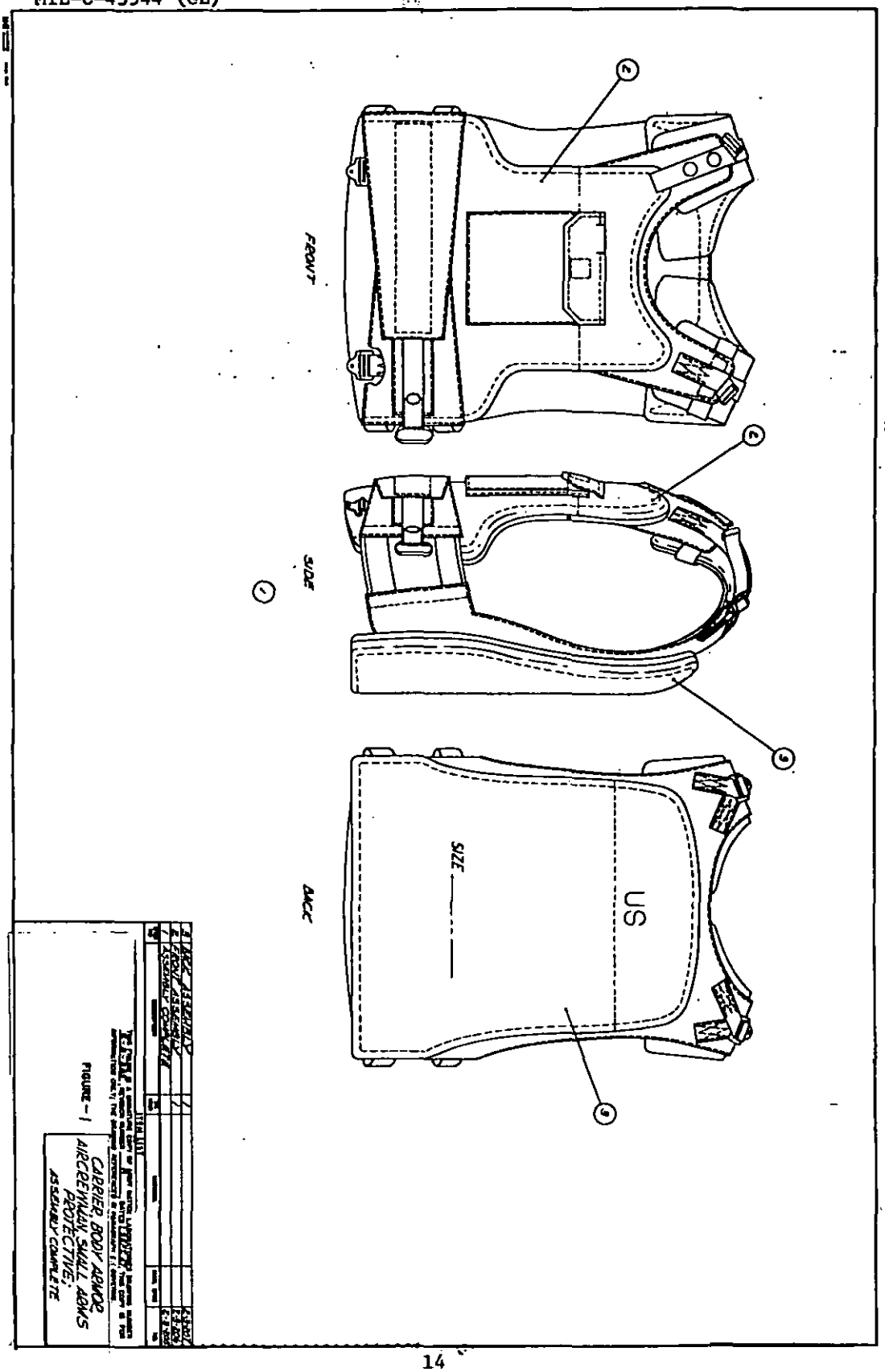
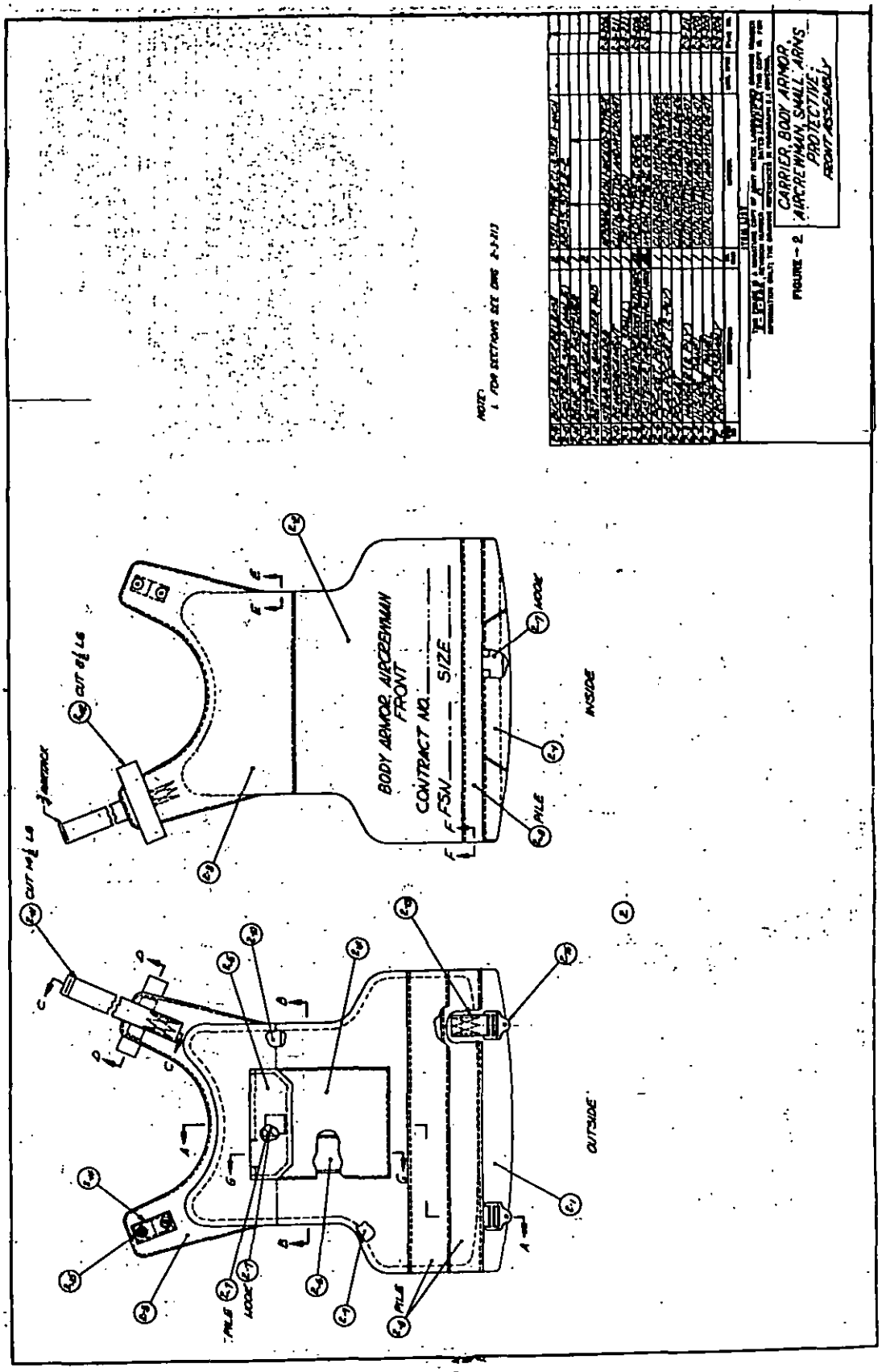
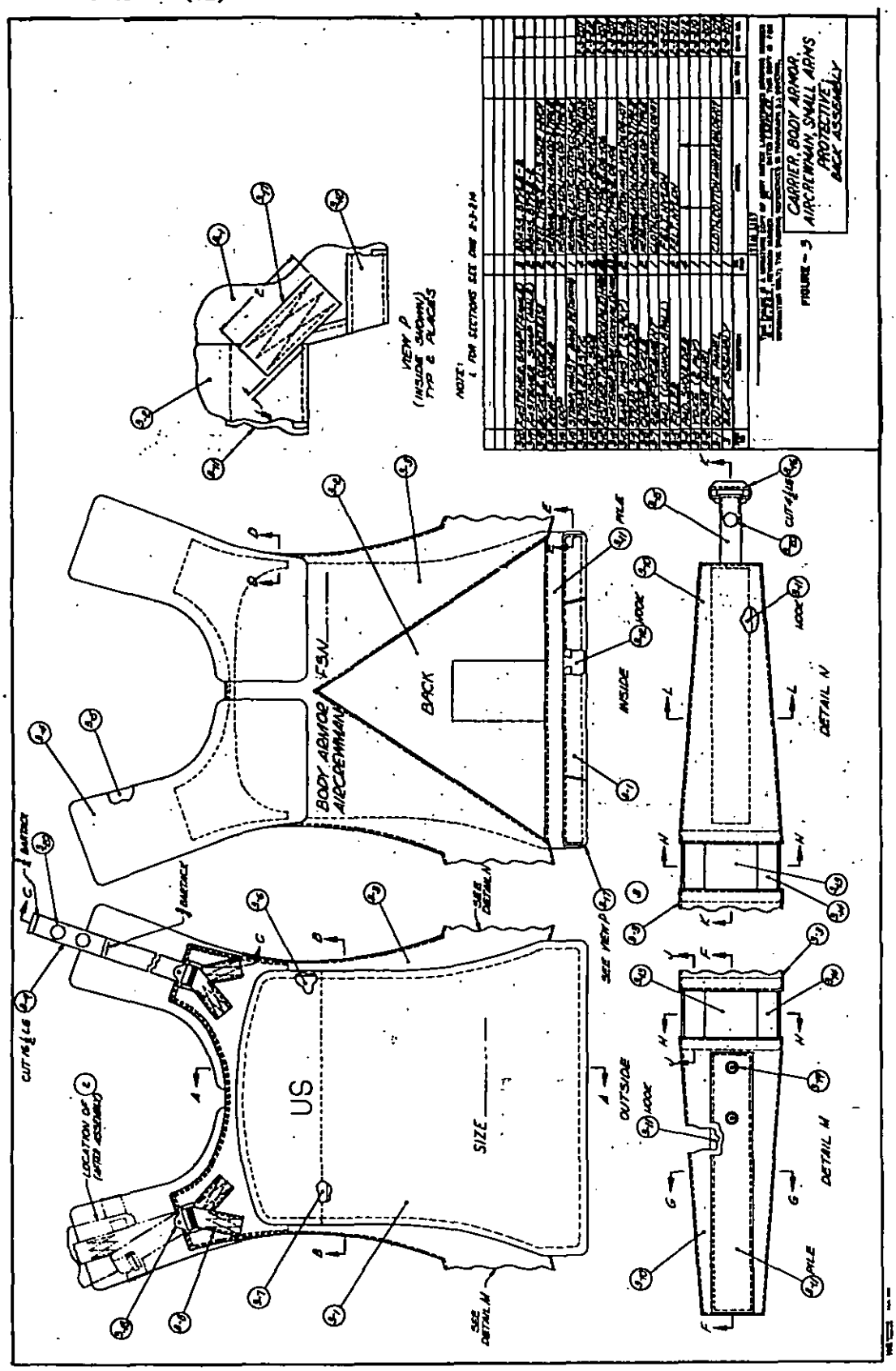


FIGURE - 1
CARRIER, BODY ARMOR, AIRCREWMAN, SMALL ARMS PROTECTIVE; ASSEMBLY COMPLETE

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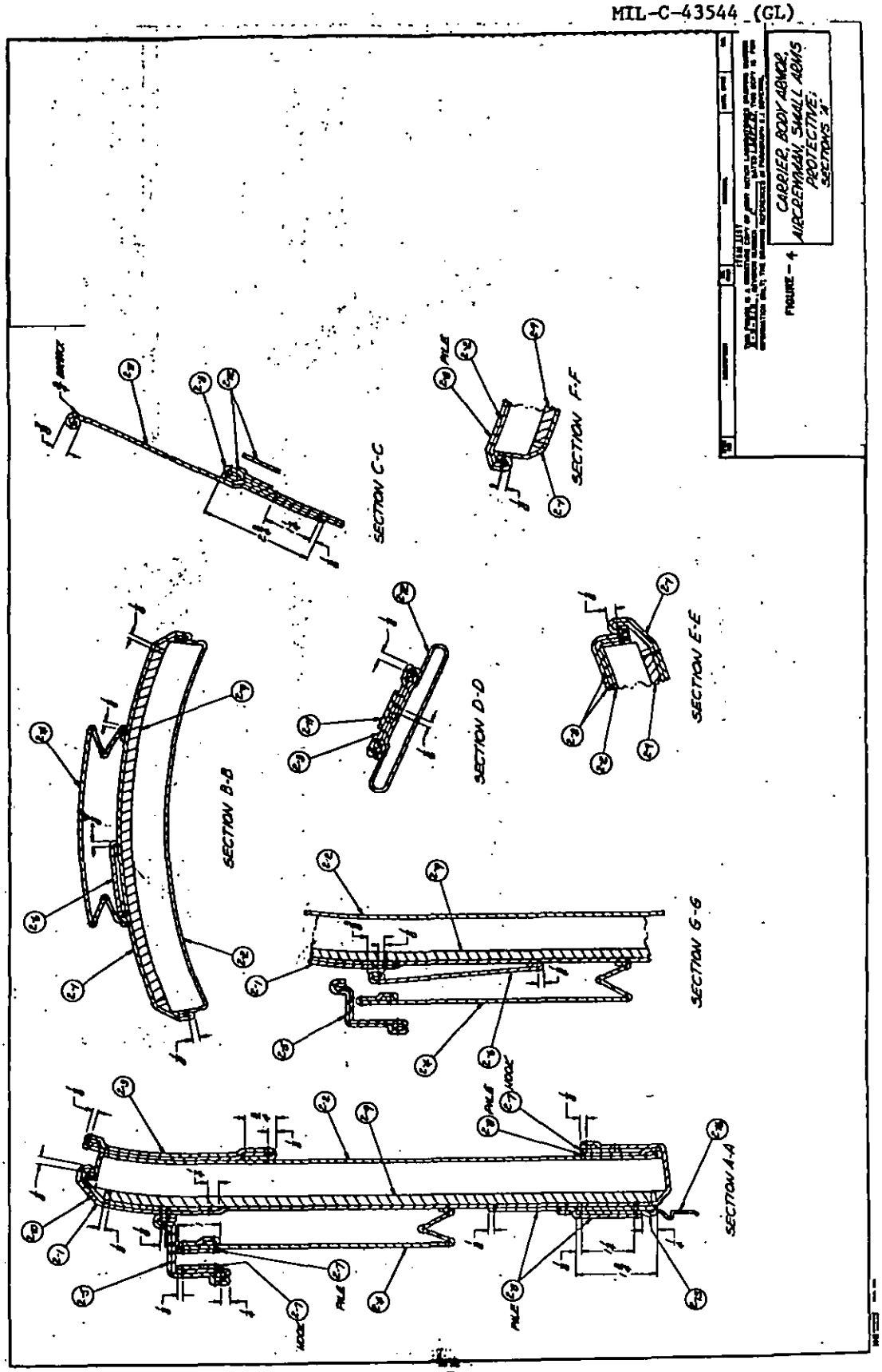


FIGURE - 4

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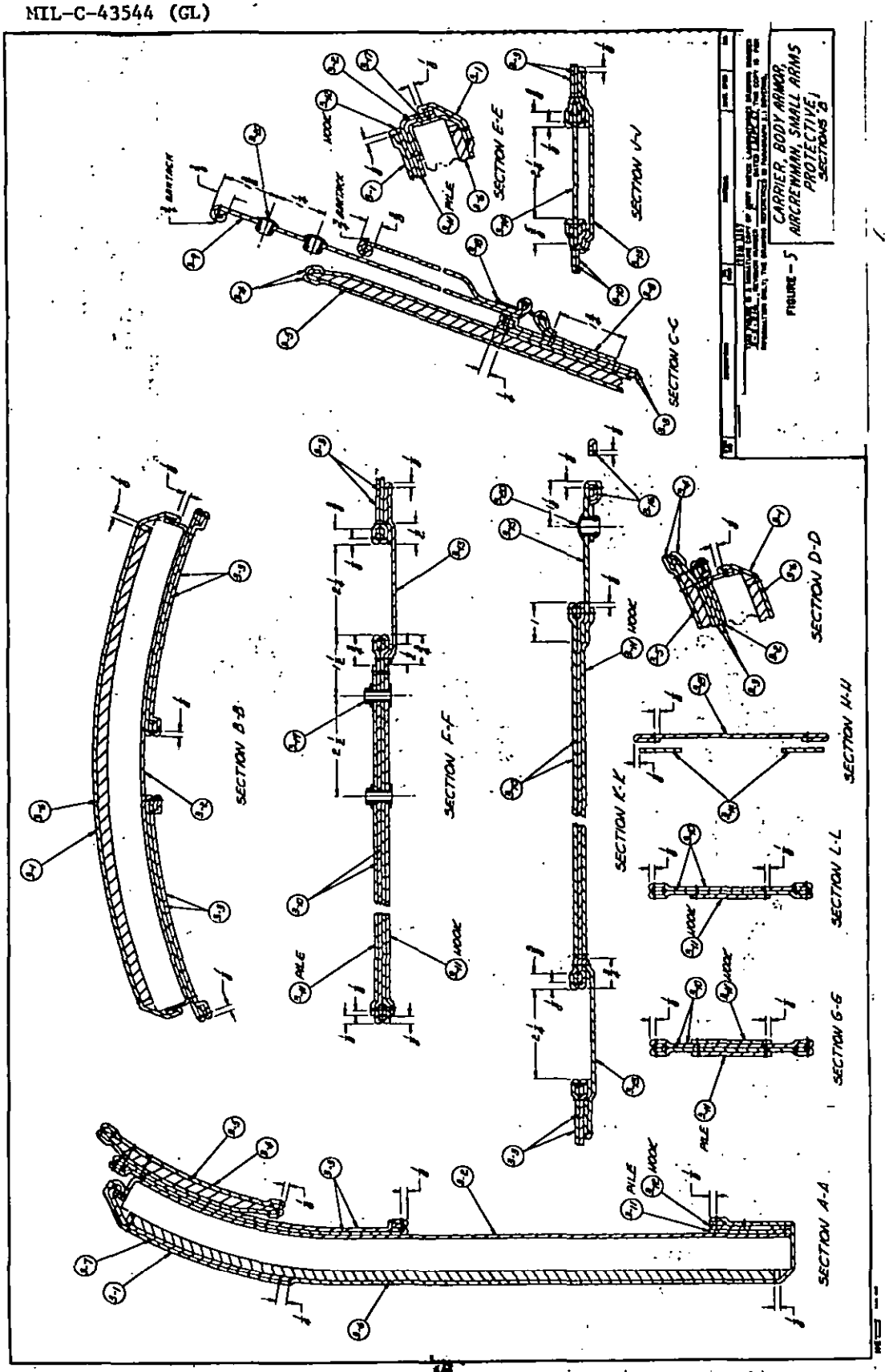


FIGURE 5

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION
Carrier, Body Armor, Aircrewman, Small Arms Protective - MIL-C-43544(GL)

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 68 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
U. S. Army Natick Laboratories
Natick, Massachusetts 01760

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